

Newspaper Stamp Tax

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Newsbooks and pamphlets appeared in England in the 1600s. The first daily newspaper, the Daily Courant, came out in 1702. Later, the government worried about radical newspapers, especially after 1789 and the Napoleonic wars.

Printing was first tightly controlled by the Licensing of the Press Act 1662. The government later introduced the Stamp Tax in 1712, called a "tax on knowledge," to control newspapers. It taxed newspapers and adverts and changed many times before ending in 1855.

After the Peterloo Massacre in 1819, the Six Acts made control stricter and caused protests and resistance in the "War of the Unstamped."

The Stamp Tax ended in 1856, and a separate paper tax ended in 1861.

Stamp Tax and Advertisement Duty

<i>Year</i>	<i>Stamp Tax (pence)</i>	<i>Advertisement Duty (pence)</i>
1712	$\frac{1}{2}$ or 1	12
1757	1	24
1776	$1\frac{1}{2}$	23
1780	$1\frac{1}{2}$	30
1789	2	36
1797	$3\frac{1}{2}$	36
1815	4	42
1833	4	18
1836	1	18
1853	1	0
1855	0	0

Values in pre-decimal currency

240 pence = 1 pound